LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Law (Advocate, Judge, Corporate Counsel, Legal Careers): Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Build reading, writing, debate and reasoning; follow current affairs	Skills tested later in CLAT / AILET (English, GK, Logical Reasoning)
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Explore interest in law; any stream is fine later	Law is open to Science, Commerce and Humanities students
Stream choice	After Class 10	Any stream in Class 11-12 (Humanities is common; Commerce and Science are also eligible)	CLAT, AILET, SLAT and other law entrance eligibility
Preparation	Class 11-12	Boards + law entrance tests (CLAT, AILET, SLAT, LSAT India)	Seats at National Law Universities and private law schools
Degree	After Class 12	5-year integrated BA LLB / BBA LLB / BCom LLB; or 3-year LLB after any graduation	Eligibility to enrol with the State Bar Council
Licence	After LLB	Enrol with State Bar Council, then pass AIBE for Certificate of Practice	Right to practise as an advocate
Specialise / serve	1-5 years later	Litigation, corporate, judiciary, LLM, public service	Senior counsel, judge, in-house counsel, academia

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-10: Foundation

- Decision: strengthen English, current affairs, logical reasoning and public speaking. Join debate, MUN, quiz and moot-style activities.
- There is no separate law exam before Class 12. Skills built now are tested in CLAT and AILET.

After Class 10: Stream choice

- Any stream works. Humanities (History, Political Science, Economics) helps with GK and legal reasoning; Commerce helps with corporate law; Science with IP, patent and cyber law.
- Karnataka note: Class 11-12 is the 2-year Pre-University Course (PUC) after SSLC; CBSE/ICSE schools run Class 11-12 directly.

Class 11-12: Preparation

- Prepare for CLAT (December), AILET (December), SLAT and other tests alongside boards; apply by the notification deadlines (typically Aug-Nov).
- Read a newspaper daily; practise passage-based reading, legal reasoning and quantitative techniques.

After Class 12: Degree

- 5-year integrated degrees: BA LLB (Hons), BBA LLB, BCom LLB. 3-year LLB is available after any graduation.
- Choice between National Law Universities (CLAT / AILET), state law universities (Karnataka: KSLU and affiliated colleges), and private law schools.

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After the degree: Licence and career

- Enrol with the State Bar Council; clear the All India Bar Examination (AIBE) to get the Certificate of Practice from the Bar Council of India.
- Paths: litigation, corporate law firms, in-house counsel, judiciary (civil judge exams), public prosecutor, legal policy, academia, LLM and PhD.

3. Early preparation (Class 6-12)

Exam / route	Conducted by	Classes	Details	Timing
Debate, MUN, moot and quiz competitions	Schools, colleges, NGOs	6-12	Builds speaking, reasoning and awareness; no formal entrance value	Through the year
NTSE	NCERT; Karnataka Stage 1 via DSERT	10	Covers Social Science and mental ability	2026-27 notification expected Aug-Oct†
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb

Tip for parents: law entrance scores depend on reading speed, vocabulary, current affairs and logic. Start newspaper reading and reasoning practice in Class 8-9.

4. Entrance exams, licensing and judicial services

CLAT (Common Law Admission Test) - UG	
Conducting body	Consortium of National Law Universities; consortiumofnlus.ac.in
Used for	BA LLB (Hons) and other integrated law programmes at National Law Universities (including NLSIU Bengaluru) and many private law schools
Eligibility	Class 12 or equivalent (appearing candidates allowed); about 45% for General (40% SC/ST)†
Frequency / date	Once a year; CLAT 2027 expected 6 December 2026 (application deadline reported 31 October 2026); official notification not seen†
Pattern	120 MCQs, 2 hours, offline: English, Current Affairs / GK, Legal Reasoning, Logical Reasoning, Quantitative Techniques; +1 / -0.25. A committee may revise the pattern†

AILET (All India Law Entrance Test) - NLU Delhi	
Conducting body	National Law University, Delhi (NLU Delhi)
Used for	BA LLB (Hons) at NLU Delhi (separate from CLAT)
Eligibility	Passed or appearing in Class 12 or equivalent†
Frequency / date	AILET 2027 on 13 December 2026, 2 to 4 pm, offline; applications open until 10 November 2026; admit card due 30 November 2026
Pattern	150 MCQs: English Language 50, Current Affairs and GK 30, Logical Reasoning 70; no separate Legal Reasoning section; +1 / -0.25

SLAT (Symbiosis Law Admission Test) and other private-law tests	
Conducting body	Symbiosis International University; other private universities run their own tests
Frequency / date	SLAT reported for December 2026 in two slots; registrations opened in August 2026†
Pattern	60 MCQs, 60 minutes, 60 marks: English, Current Affairs and GK, Logical Reasoning, Legal Reasoning, Quantitative Aptitude†
LSAT India	Accepted by several private law schools; dates, eligibility and pattern not confirmed at the time of compilation†

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Karnataka State Law University (KSLU) and affiliated colleges	
Programmes	5-year integrated BA LLB and BBA LLB (need 10+2); 3-year LLB (needs any graduation); LLM
Admission	Most sources say merit on qualifying marks with no entrance test; one source mentions a KSLU CET†
Timing	Application form expected April-July after PUC / degree results; dates not confirmed†

AIBE (All India Bar Examination) - Bar Council of India	
Conducting body	Bar Council of India (BCI); allindiabarexamination.com
Eligibility	Degree in law (3-year or 5-year LLB) from a BCI-recognised university; final-year students may register, with the enrolment certificate due after results†
Frequency / date	AIBE XXI held on 7 June 2026; AIBE XXII scheduled for 29 November 2026; BCI told the Supreme Court it would hold AIBE twice a year†
Pattern	Offline OMR, 3 hours 30 minutes, 100 MCQs, 1 mark each, no negative marking; open book (bare Acts allowed); syllabus now includes the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita and Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam
Passing	45 out of 100 for General and OBC; 40 for SC/ST
Result	Certificate of Practice, mandatory to practise law in India

Judicial services (Civil Judge exams)	
Conducting body	State Public Service Commissions with High Courts; in Karnataka, KPSC with the High Court†
Eligibility	LLB (3-year or 5-year) from a BCI-recognised university; minimum age about 21-22 and maximum 32-42 by state; practice requirement reported as 1 year (from April 2027 notifications) or 3 years after a May 2025 Supreme Court ruling, sources conflict†
Karnataka	No 2026 KPSC notification or age table found at the time of compilation†

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
CLAT-PG	Consortium of NLUs	LLM at National Law Universities	Once a year†
UGC-NET (Law)	NTA	Lectureship and research	Twice a year†
State judicial services exams	State PSCs	Civil Judge / Magistrate	Per state notification†

5. Scholarships and financial support

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
NLU and private law school scholarships	Universities and foundations	Merit and need based	Varies	Check each university†
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†

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Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†

Note: INSPIRE-SHE is for natural and basic sciences and does not apply to law students.†

6. Courses, training and institutions

Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
BA LLB (Hons)	5 yr	CLAT, AILET, SLAT, college tests	Most common integrated degree
BBA LLB / BCom LLB	5 yr	CLAT, AILET, SLAT, college tests	Corporate and business law focus
LLB	3 yr	After any graduation; university or state tests	Route for graduates from any stream
LLM	1-2 yr	CLAT-PG and university tests	Specialisation: corporate, IP, constitutional, tax, environment, international
PhD in Law / Judicial services preparation	3+ yr	UGC-NET, university tests	Academic and judicial careers

Examples of institutions (illustrative, not a ranking): NLSIU Bengaluru, NLU Delhi, NALSAR Hyderabad, NLIU Bhopal, WBNUJS Kolkata, Symbiosis Law School, Christ University School of Law, Jindal Global Law School, KSLU and affiliated colleges.†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Litigation	Advocate, senior counsel, public prosecutor, legal aid lawyer	Specialisation, Senior Advocate designation
Corporate and commercial law	Law firm associate, in-house counsel, compliance officer, M&A lawyer	LLM, MBA
Judiciary	Civil Judge, Magistrate, District Judge, Judge of the High Court (by seniority or direct recruitment)	Judicial services exams
Public sector and policy	Legal officer, law officer in government, policy researcher, legislative drafter	UPSC, LLM, public policy
Technology and IP	IP attorney, cyber-law specialist, data-privacy counsel	LLM in IP / technology law
Academia and media	Law professor, researcher, legal journalist, writer	LLM, PhD, UGC-NET

8. Related umbrellas this one connects to

- Commerce: BBA LLB / BCom LLB and corporate law connect directly (see Commerce document).
- Arts and Humanities: Political Science, History and Psychology feed legal reasoning and public policy (see Arts and Humanities document).
- Civil services and policy: law graduates commonly appear for UPSC; Law is also an optional subject.†
- Defence: law graduates can apply for Judge Advocate General (JAG) branches in the armed forces.†
- Technology: cyber law, data protection and IP overlap with Science and Engineering.

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ONE-PAGE GIST: Law

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-10	Build reading, English and reasoning; debate and quiz
After Class 10	Any stream; Humanities or Commerce is common; PUC in Karnataka
Class 11-12	Boards + CLAT, AILET, SLAT, LSAT India; read daily news
After Class 12	5-year BA LLB / BBA LLB (or 3-year LLB after any graduation)
After LLB	Enrol with State Bar Council; pass AIBE for Certificate of Practice
Career	Advocate, corporate counsel, judge, prosecutor, policy, academia; LLM / PhD

Exam / route	When	Pattern / key point	Marking
CLAT	December (2027: expected 6 Dec 2026)	120 MCQs, 2 hr; English, GK, Legal, Logical, Quant	+1 / -0.25
AILET	13 Dec 2026 (for 2027 intake)	150 Q, 2 hr: English 50, GK 30, Logical 70	+1 / -0.25
SLAT	December†	60 MCQs, 60 min	Check notification
AIBE	Twice a year (XXII: 29 Nov 2026)	100 MCQs, 3.5 hr, open book	No negative; pass 45 / 40
Civil Judge	Per state notification	Prelims, Mains, Interview	Check notification

Key rules: CLAT needs about 45% in Class 12 (40% SC/ST); LLB needs graduation; AIBE is mandatory to practise.†

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8), CSSS (UG), post-matric schemes via NSP / SSP, university scholarships.†

Careers: advocate, corporate lawyer, judge, public prosecutor, IP attorney, legal journalist, professor.

Want a personalised roadmap or counselling? Contact LessonPlan, Yelahanka, Bangalore.

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